

Regarding conducting a survey of persons with disabilities in the State...

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Disability Welfare Department

Government Resolution No.: Divyang-2024/C.R.36/Divyang Kalyan-3

31, 32, 35 A, 3rd Floor, A-Wing, Mittal Tower,

Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021.

Date :- 16 March, 2024

Read :- 1. Minutes of the meeting held on 09th November, 2022 under the Chairmanship of Hon'ble Chief Minister.

Preamble :-

According to the 2011 Census, the number of persons with disabilities (as per 7 types) in the State is 29.63 lakh, which constitutes 2.6% of the total population. As per the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, 21 types of disabilities have been specified. Accordingly, a significant increase in the number of persons with disabilities in the State is expected.

According to Chapter 3, Section 17(1) of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016, the requirement to conduct a survey of school students every 5 years to impart inclusive education has been specified. Also, conducting a survey of all disabled students in the State within 2 years of the enforcement of the law has been indicated. Similarly, according to Chapter 5, Section 2 (A), the State Government and local self-government bodies should prepare initiatives/schemes for health facilities and preventive measures against disability for persons with disabilities. Accordingly, provisions have been made regarding conducting survey, examination, and research to ascertain the causes of disability.

Accurate records of the total population of persons with disabilities or their socio-economic status are not available with the Central Government or the State Government. On the basis of detailed information obtained from the survey of persons with disabilities, the Government is determined to empower persons with disabilities and bring them into the mainstream of society by planning various initiatives and schemes for their holistic development (education, training, rehabilitation, financial assistance, social security, affirmative action schemes). For this, accurate data of persons with disabilities district/taluka-wise and village-wise, as well as according to various types of disabilities, is required to be available, so that it becomes convenient to provide them government schemes and other facilities according to the type of disability. Earlier, the decision to conduct a survey of physically disabled persons at the taluka level in the State was taken vide Government Resolution of the Public Health Department dated 08.02.1994. Nearly a period of 30 years has elapsed since the said survey was conducted. To collect information for formulation and effective implementation of schemes, programs, projects for persons with disabilities, to identify the problems/needs of persons with disabilities for conducting research regarding persons with disabilities, and to collect information with a view to rehabilitate persons with disabilities holistically and bring them into the mainstream of society, the matter of launching a scheme to conduct a door-to-door survey of persons with disabilities in the State was under the consideration of the Government.

Government Resolution :-

Since having accurate data of persons with disabilities in the State is necessary, conducting a survey of persons with disabilities in the State is essential. Due to the lack of accurate records of persons with disabilities in the State, difficulties are being faced in framing new schemes and formulating policies for persons with disabilities. By conducting a socio-economic survey of persons with disabilities and collecting their detailed information, schemes can be prepared to bring them into the mainstream of society, to understand their problems, and to provide help to them. To enable implementation of measures such as conducting awareness campaigns in society to understand health, employment, self-employment, education, training, causes of disability for persons with disabilities; identifying disability at an early age to reduce it, detecting, early diagnosis and treatment, encouraging their rehabilitation, etc., as it is necessary to conduct a survey of persons with disabilities in the State, sanction is hereby accorded vide this Government Resolution to the "**Survey of Persons with Disabilities in the State**" scheme.

Main Objectives of the Survey Program of Persons with Disabilities:

- I. To conduct a survey of persons with disabilities in the State.
- II. To make available data of persons with 21 types of disabilities specified as per the Act of 2016 in the State.
- III. To collect data for formulation and effective implementation of schemes, programs, and projects for persons with disabilities.
- IV. To identify problems/needs of persons with disabilities for conducting research regarding persons with disabilities.
- V. To collect information with a view to holistically rehabilitate persons with disabilities and bring them into the mainstream.

Scope:

- I. The survey of persons with disabilities in the State will be conducted across all cities, villages, wadis-vastis, tandas, and padas, etc.
- II. It will also be implemented across all Municipal Corporations, Municipal Councils, Nagar Panchayats, Gram Panchayats, Cantonment Boards, etc.

Administrative Nodal Officer :-

For the survey of persons with disabilities in the district, the Collector of the concerned district and in the Municipal Corporation area, the concerned Commissioner will act as the Nodal Officer.

Committee at the Field Level :-

To select an agency/organization for the survey of persons with disabilities as well as to coordinate among them, a committee is hereby constituted under the Chairmanship of the concerned Collector as follows :-

- i. District Collector – Chairperson
- ii. Chief Executive Officer, Zilla Parishad – Member

- iii. District Health Officer, Zilla Parishad – Member
- iv. District Women and Child Development Officer – Member
- v. District Social Welfare Officer – Member Secretary

To select an agency/organization for the survey of persons with disabilities as well as to coordinate among them, a committee is hereby constituted under the Chairmanship of the concerned Commissioner, Municipal Corporation as follows :-

1. Commissioner - Chairperson
2. Deputy Commissioner (Health) - Member
3. Deputy Commissioner (Women and Child Development) - Member
4. Assistant Commissioner / District Social Welfare Officer - Member Secretary

Questionnaire for the Survey:

To ensure uniformity in the survey across all districts, the survey questionnaire will be made available by the Government.

If it is deemed necessary to include additional information in the questionnaire provided by the Government to maintain uniformity in the survey across all districts, approval of the Secretary, Disability Welfare shall be obtained for the same.

Training material, methodology, and schedule will be determined through the selected Non-Governmental Organization (NGO).

Training:

Training material, methodology, and schedule will be determined through the selected Non-Governmental Organization. Training will be imparted to ASHA workers / Anganwadi workers at the village level through ASHA Group Promoters. Teams of ASHA Group Promoters / Anganwadi workers shall be formed.

Public Participation:

- i. Planning and inauguration of the survey in their jurisdiction should be done in consultation with Hon'ble Corporators in Municipal Corporation / Municipal Council areas.
- ii. Planning and inauguration of the survey in their jurisdiction should be done in consultation with Sarpanch / Gram Panchayat members in rural areas.

Terms and Conditions:

1. The District Collector / Commissioner, Municipal Corporation shall act as the Nodal Officer for the survey of persons with disabilities.
2. For the work of the disability survey, the District Collector / Commissioner, Municipal Corporation shall select a Non-Governmental Organization following the prescribed procedure.

3. The survey work will be carried out through ASHA workers / Anganwadi workers / Health workers.
4. To ensure uniformity in the survey work, the questionnaire will be provided by the Government to each district.
5. The Commissioner, Disability Welfare, Pune shall function as the Controlling and Coordinating Officer for the survey.
6. After the selection of Non-Governmental Organizations, the Commissioner, Disability Welfare, Pune shall submit the district-wise list of organizations selected for the survey to the Government.
7. The survey work has been completed in Akola, Parbhani, Satara districts of the State, and the survey work is ongoing in Beed, Dhule, and Thane districts; excluding the said 6 districts, funds amounting to Rs. 25 Lakhs will be distributed to initiate the survey work for the remaining 30 districts.
8. 50% amount will be paid after completion of the survey work, and the remaining funds will be released after evaluation of the final report.
9. The period for the disability survey will initially be for 2 months. Thereafter, the said period will be extended as per requirement.

The Commissioner, Commissionerate for Disability Welfare, Pune shall be the Controlling Officer for this scheme. The expenditure on these items should be debited under the following Head of Account and met from the sanctioned provision for the financial year 2023-24 :-

**Demand No. ZI-3,
2235 Social Security and Welfare,
02 Social Welfare,
101 Welfare of Handicapped,
(05) Other Schemes for Disabled,
(05) (17) Survey of Persons with Disabilities in the State (General) (Program)
(2235 D168)
50, Other Expenditure.**

This Government Resolution is available on the website of the Government of Maharashtra www.maharashtra.gov.in and its computer code number is 202403161549384735. This Government Resolution is being issued certified with a digital signature.

By order and in the name of the Governor of Maharashtra,

(Adhikrao Ba. Budhe)

Under Secretary, Government of Maharashtra

Copy to:

- 1) Principal Secretary to Hon'ble Governor, Raj Bhavan, Malabar Hill, Mumbai

- 2) Additional Chief Secretary to Hon'ble Chief Minister, Chief Minister's Secretariat, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 3) Private Secretary to Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 4) Private Secretary to All Hon'ble Ministers/Hon'ble Ministers of State, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 5) Hon'ble Chairman, Maharashtra Legislative Council, Maharashtra State Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
- 6) Hon'ble Speaker, Maharashtra Legislative Assembly, Maharashtra State Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
- 7) Hon'ble Leader of Opposition, Maharashtra Legislative Council, Maharashtra State Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
- 8) Hon'ble Leader of Opposition, Maharashtra Legislative Assembly, Maharashtra State Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
- 9) All Additional Chief Secretaries / Principal Secretaries / Secretaries, Mantralaya Departments, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 10) Commissioner, Municipal Corporation (All)
- 11) District Collector, Collector Office, District (All)
- 12) Chief Executive Officer, Zilla Parishad, District (All)
- 13) Chief Officer, Municipal Council / Nagar Parishad (All)
- 14) Personal Assistant to Hon'ble Minister (Disability Welfare Department)
- 15) Personal Assistant to Secretary (Disability Welfare Department)
- 16) Commissioner, Disability Welfare, Maharashtra State, Pune
- 17) Deputy Secretary / Under Secretary (Divyang Kalyan-3), Disability Welfare Department, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 18) Under Secretary / Section Officer, Desk-Divyang Kalyan-2, Disability Welfare Department, Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 19) Section Officer, Finance Department (Expenditure-14 / Ways & Means / Budget / SAU), Mantralaya, Mumbai
- 20) Accountant General (A&E/Audit) Maharashtra 1/2, Mumbai/Nagpur
- 21) Accountant General (Audit), Maharashtra 1/2, Mumbai/Nagpur
- 22) Pay and Accounts Officer, Mumbai
- 23) District Treasury Officer, Mumbai/Thane
- 24) Resident Audit Officer, Mumbai
- 25) Additional Treasury Officer, Konkan Bhavan, Navi Mumbai
- 26) Select File (Divyang Kalyan-3)